TOPIC 02 · DATA ANALYTICS AND VISUALIZATION
LAB 5 THEME · TABLES, TRACKERS & CONDITIONAL FORMATTING

Lab 5 — Build a Colour-Coded Interview Tracker from Unstructured Notes

Maps to	LO2: use Gemini to turn unstructured notes into a formatted table, build a tracker with dropdowns and checkboxes, and apply and edit conditional-formatting rules on HR data
Duration	30 minutes
Tools	Google Sheets · Gemini (create tables, Insert, dropdown, checkbox and conditional-formatting actions, Settings) · OrchidBay_Interview_Tracker.xlsx
Mock data	data/OrchidBay_Interview_Tracker.xlsx
Course	Gemini for Google Sheet (C817) · v2.0
Prompts	https://tertiarycourses.github.io/C817-Gemini-for-Google-Sheet/prompts/#lab-5

Goal

Turn a week of typed interview notes into a colour-coded tracker, and flag the strongest, most expensive and slowest-to-start candidates on the shortlist.

What You Will Do

The recruiters typed this week's interview notes as free text. You will ask Gemini to turn them into a structured table, refine it before inserting, and make it a working tracker with Status and Outcome dropdowns and a Reference_Checked checkbox. Conditional-formatting actions colour-code the tracker and flag the shortlist: top screening scores, salaries above budget and long notice periods. You will edit a rule with Settings, run a multi-step clean-up prompt, and create an onboarding checklist from scratch.

What You Will Build

OrchidBay_Interview_Tracker with an Interview_Tracker tab (12 interviews, dropdowns, checkboxes, colour-coded Status), a flagged Shortlist tab and a new Onboarding_Checklist tab

Prerequisites

- Topic 1 completed: you can open the Gemini side panel, insert results and apply actions.
- This lab folder downloaded, including data/OrchidBay_Interview_Tracker.xlsx.

Data note

Use only the supplied fictional Orchid Bay data or information you are authorised to process. Do not paste credentials, confidential business material or real candidates' or employees' personal data into Gemini, the AI function or a Gem unless your organisation has approved it.

Steps

Step 1. Download OrchidBay_Interview_Tracker.xlsx from this lab's data folder. In Google Drive choose New > File upload, open the uploaded file, then choose File > Save as Google Sheets - Gemini works best on a native Google Sheets file. Close the .xlsx tab and work only in the new Google Sheets copy. At the top right, click Ask Gemini (the spark icon) to open the Gemini side panel. Read the About_This_Data tab before you prompt.

PROMPT / CHECK — copy and adapt

```
Required state:
File : OrchidBay_Interview_Tracker (Google Sheets copy)
Tabs : About_This_Data | Interview_Notes (12 lines) | Shortlist (43 rows) | Prompt_Log
```

Step 2. Ask Gemini to build a table from the notes. Read the draft in the panel and refine it with the follow-up before you insert it. Check that it has 12 rows and that every Status is one of the four options: Completed 5, Scheduled 3, Rescheduled 2, No-show 2. Click Insert, put it on a new tab and rename the tab Interview_Tracker.

PROMPT / CHECK — copy and adapt

```
INSERT:
Using the notes on the Interview_Notes tab, create a table with the columns Date, Time,
Candidate, Candidate_ID, Position, Panel, Format and Status. Status must be one of Scheduled,
Completed, No-show or Rescheduled.

FOLLOW-UP:
Add two empty columns at the end: Outcome and Reference_Checked.
```

Step 3. Make it a working tracker. Send these one at a time on the Interview_Tracker tab and click Apply on each action card. Test a dropdown by clicking a Status cell.

PROMPT / CHECK — copy and adapt

```
ACTION:
1) Make the Status column a dropdown with the options Scheduled, Completed, No-show and
Rescheduled.
2) Create a dropdown in the Outcome column with the options Pending, Advance, Hold and Reject.
3) Insert checkboxes in the Reference_Checked column, unchecked by default.
```

Step 4. Colour-code the Status column. When the action finishes, click Settings to see the rules Gemini created (the same rules are in Format > Conditional formatting). Change one Status to No-show and watch the colour change, then change it back.

PROMPT / CHECK — copy and adapt

```
ACTION:
Colour-code the Status column: Completed light green, Scheduled light blue, Rescheduled amber
and No-show light red.
```

Step 5. Switch to the Shortlist tab and flag it one rule at a time. Expect 11 light-green rows (score 85 or more), 12 red salaries above budget, and a colour scale on Interview_Score (blank cells stay white).

PROMPT / CHECK — copy and adapt

```
ACTION:
1) On the Shortlist tab, highlight the rows where Screening_Score is 85 or more in light
green.
2) Make Expected_Salary bold red when it is greater than Budget_Max on the same row.
3) Add a colour scale to Interview_Score from red for low values to green for high values.
```

Step 6. Edit a rule instead of starting again: open Format > Conditional formatting (or Settings on the first card), choose the green rule and change 85 to 80. Then ask Gemini to count the green rows and check its answer with the formula - both should be 21.

PROMPT / CHECK — copy and adapt

```
ASK GEMINI:
On the Shortlist tab, how many rows have a Screening_Score of 80 or more? Which positions are
they for?

CHECK:
Score 80 or more =COUNTIF(Shortlist!E2:E44,">=80")
Above budget =SUMPRODUCT(--(Shortlist!G2:G44>Shortlist!H2:H44))
```

Step 7. One multi-step prompt can do several actions. Check every part: Stage has a dropdown, Notice_End shows dates, Contacted has checkboxes, and 5 rows are light orange.

PROMPT / CHECK — copy and adapt

```
ACTION:
Clean up the Shortlist tracker: make the Stage column a dropdown with Shortlisted, Interviewed
and Offered; add a new column Notice_End at the end with a formula for 30 September 2026 plus
Notice_Weeks weeks, formatted as a date; add a checkbox column called Contacted; and highlight
in light orange the rows where Notice_Weeks is more than 8.
```

Step 8. Create a table from scratch - no data needed. Refine it, then Insert it on a new tab named Onboarding_Checklist.

PROMPT / CHECK — copy and adapt

```
INSERT:
Create an onboarding checklist tracker for a new hire in Singapore, with the columns Task,
Owner, Days_Before_Start, Status and Done. Include 10 typical tasks. Make Done a checkbox.

FOLLOW-UP:
Add 3 tasks for laptop, system access and security training, owned by IT.
```

Step 9. Prompt_Log already lists every prompt in this lab with its step. Ask Gemini to recap the conversation, copy each line into What Gemini did, add How I verified in your own words, and choose Keep, Revise or Undo in the Decision dropdown. Google Sheets saves automatically. Tip: the side-panel history is lost when you reload the page, so insert or copy anything you want to keep.

PROMPT / CHECK — copy and adapt

```
LOG:
List the prompts I sent you in this conversation. For each one, give a one-line summary of
what you did, so I can copy it into the Prompt_Log tab.
```

Sample Prompts

Use these prompts in the Gemini side panel in Google Sheets (or adapt them). Name the tab and columns, state the output, and always verify the result. The same prompts are in sample-prompts.txt in this lab folder.

Copy-ready prompts online: https://tertiarycourses.github.io/C817-Gemini-for-Google-Sheet/prompts/#lab-5

#	Purpose	Prompt
1	Table	Create a table of interview questions for a Data Analyst, with columns Question, Skill tested and What a good answer includes.
2	Dropdown	Convert the Recruiter column on the Shortlist tab to a dropdown with values from the same column.
3	Highlight	Highlight the Shortlist rows where Stage is Offered in light purple.
4	Freeze	Freeze the top row and the first two columns of the Shortlist tab.
5	Help	Teach me how to use conditional formatting with a custom formula.

Test It

Check	Expected result
Interview_Tracker	12 rows; Completed 5, Scheduled 3, Rescheduled 2, No-show 2.
Tracker controls	Status and Outcome dropdowns work; Reference_Checked has checkboxes; Status is colour-coded.
Shortlist flags	11 green rows at 85, then 21 after editing the rule to 80; 12 salaries in bold red; Interview_Score has a colour scale.
Multi-step	Stage dropdown, Notice_End dates, Contacted checkboxes; 5 light-orange rows.
Onboarding_Checklist	13 tasks (10 + 3 IT tasks) with a Done checkbox column.

Checkpoint

Lab 6 opens a separate profiles workbook, so you can start it even if this tracker is unfinished.

Troubleshooting

If this happens	Fix
The table from the notes has wrong statuses.	Use Retry, or a follow-up: 'done or completed means Completed; moved means Rescheduled; did not turn up means No-show; confirmed or accepted means Scheduled.'
Insert put the table on top of the notes.	Undo. Insert it on a new tab, or select an empty cell on a new tab before clicking Insert.
The row highlight colours only one cell.	Undo and say 'highlight the whole row'. In Format > Conditional formatting the custom formula needs $ before the column, e.g. =$E2>=85, applied to A2:K44.
Dropdown or checkbox actions are not offered.	Use the menu: select the column > Insert > Dropdown (or Data > Data validation), and Insert > Checkbox.
No Settings button appears.	Settings appears only for actions with configurable settings. Use Format > Conditional formatting.

Challenge

Ask Gemini to add a Days_To_Start column and highlight anyone who cannot start before 1 December 2026.

Reflection

Which flag on the Shortlist would change a hiring manager's decision, and which is only 'nice to know'?